



Muslim Struggle for creation of Pakistan

**MAJOR POLITICAL AND CONSTITUTIONAL DEVELOPMENTS OF SUB-
CONTINENT 1900-1940.**

Introduction

- ▶ In the early 20th century, British India was a diverse region with various religious, cultural, and ethnic groups. The political landscape was dominated by the Indian National Congress, which primarily represented Hindu interests, while Muslims, who were a significant minority, felt marginalized and sought their own political identity.

Early Political Awareness (1900-1910)

- ▶ **Formation of Muslim League (1906):** The All-India Muslim League was established in Dhaka (now Bangladesh) to safeguard the rights of Muslims in India. The League aimed to protect Muslim interests against the majority Hindu population's dominance and sought to promote loyalty to the British government as a means to secure Muslim rights.
- ▶ **Partition of Bengal (1905-1911):** The British partitioned Bengal to create a Muslim-majority province in the east, intending to better manage the region. This move was initially welcomed by Muslims but faced strong opposition from Hindus, leading to its reversal in 1911. The event highlighted the growing communal divide and the need for Muslims to have a separate political platform.

The Lucknow Pact (1916)

- ▶ **Hindu-Muslim Unity:** The Lucknow Pact was a significant moment of Hindu-Muslim cooperation, where the Congress and the Muslim League agreed to a joint political platform. The pact included provisions for separate electorates for Muslims and reserved seats in legislatures, showing an acknowledgment of Muslim political autonomy within a united India.

Montagu-Chelmsford Reforms (1919)

- ▶ **Political Reforms:** These reforms introduced dyarchy, where certain powers were transferred to Indian ministers in provincial governments, but key areas like defense and finance remained under British control. The reforms were seen as inadequate by many Muslims, as they did not fully address their demands for greater representation and autonomy.
- ▶ **Khilafat Movement (1919-1924):** This movement was launched to protest the dismemberment of the Ottoman Empire after World War I, which Muslims considered the caliphate. The movement gained widespread support among Indian Muslims and brought them into closer alliance with Congress, but the failure of the movement and the violent aftermath of the Non-Cooperation Movement led to disillusionment and a shift towards a more distinct Muslim political identity.

Nehru Report (1928)

- ▶ **Muslim Response:** The Nehru Report, authored by Motilal Nehru, proposed a new constitutional framework for India, which rejected separate electorates and other safeguards for Muslims. This led to widespread dissatisfaction among Muslims, who saw it as a denial of their political rights. The Muslim League, under Jinnah's leadership, demanded the protection of Muslim rights, leading to growing support for the idea of a separate Muslim state.

Allama Iqbal's Allahabad Address (1930)

- ▶ **Vision for a Separate State:** During his address at the annual session of the Muslim League in Allahabad, Allama Iqbal proposed the idea of an independent Muslim state in the north-western regions of India. Iqbal's vision was based on the idea that Muslims were a distinct nation that needed its own political and territorial sovereignty to safeguard their cultural and religious identity.

Round Table Conferences (1930-1932)

- ▶ **Constitutional Negotiations:** These conferences were organized by the British government to discuss constitutional reforms in India with representatives of various political groups. The Muslim League participated actively, with Jinnah emphasizing the need for adequate safeguards for Muslims. However, the conferences ended without a clear agreement, deepening the divide between the Muslim League and the Congress.

Government of India Act (1935)

- ▶ **Limited Reforms:** The act was the most comprehensive constitutional reform introduced by the British, establishing provincial autonomy and a federal structure. However, the act did not satisfy the aspirations of the Muslim League, which felt that it did not provide adequate protections for Muslims in a predominantly Hindu India. The League's distrust of Congress intensified after the act's implementation.

Elections of 1937

- ▶ **Muslim League's Poor Performance:** In the provincial elections held under the Government of India Act, 1935, the Muslim League performed poorly, winning only a few seats. This was a turning point for the League, as it realized the need for stronger organization and leadership to represent Muslim interests. The Congress's subsequent refusal to share power with the League in provinces where it had won further alienated Muslims, reinforcing the demand for a separate state.

Lahore Resolution (1940)

- ▶ **Demand for Pakistan:** At its annual session in Lahore, the Muslim League, led by Muhammad Ali Jinnah, formally demanded the creation of independent states in the north-western and eastern zones of India, where Muslims were in the majority. This resolution, later known as the Lahore Resolution or Pakistan Resolution, was a clear call for the creation of Pakistan, marking the shift from seeking autonomy within India to demanding complete independence.

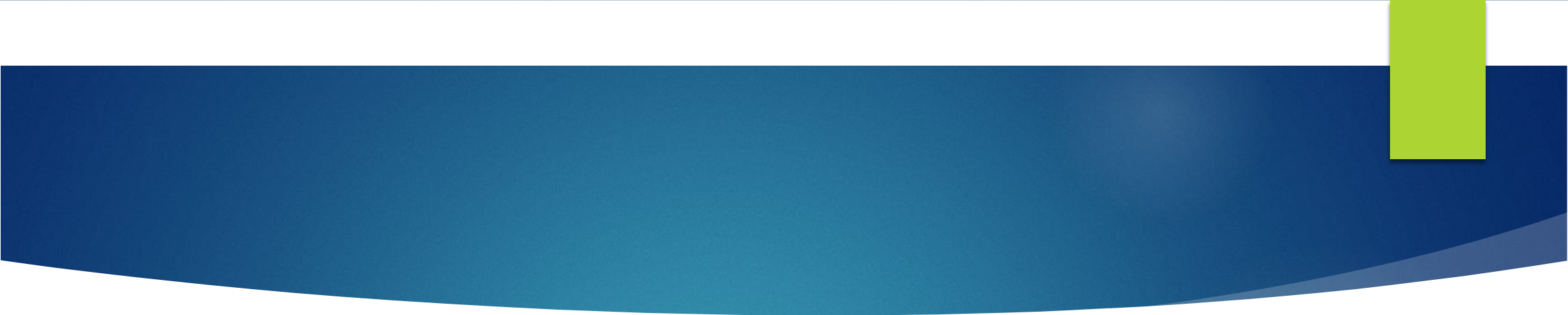
Road to Independence

Quit India Movement(1942)

- ▶ Congress launches the Quit India Movement demanding an end to British rule, but the Muslim League does not support it, focusing instead on its demand for Pakistan.

Gandhi-Jinnah Talks(1944)

- ▶ - Mahatma Gandhi and Muhammad Ali Jinnah hold talks to resolve the Hindu-Muslim issue, but the negotiations fail due to deep differences over the future structure of India.



Simla Conference and General Elections (1945-1946)

- ▶ The Simla Conference fails to reach an agreement on India's future, and in the 1946 general elections, the Muslim League wins almost all Muslim seats, strengthening its demand for Pakistan.

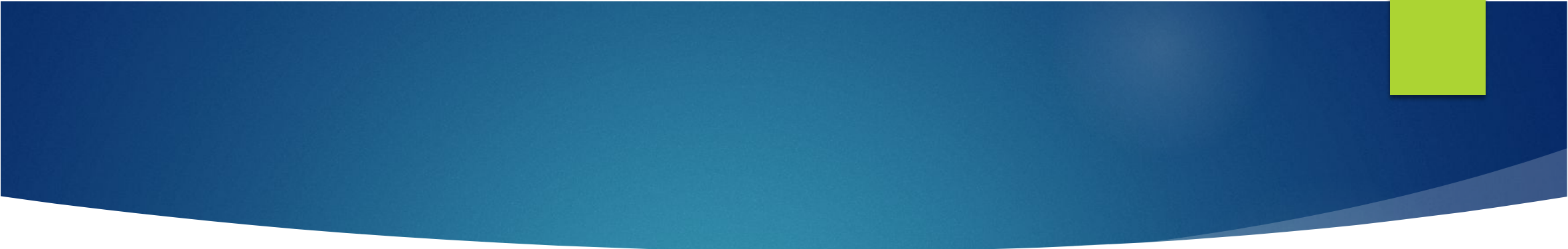
Cabinet Mission Plan (1946)

- ▶ - The British government proposes a plan for a united India with a weak central government, but Jinnah insists on the creation of Pakistan, leading to its rejection by the Muslim League.

June 3rd Plan (Mountbatten Plan) (1947)

- ▶ The British government, led by Lord Mountbatten, announces the June 3rd Plan, which outlines the process for the partition of British India into two independent dominions India and Pakistan. This plan sets the stage for the final boundary demarcation and the transfer of power.

This event was crucial as it laid the groundwork for the formal partition and independence of Pakistan and India later that year.



Direct Action Day(1946)

- ▶ The Muslim League calls for Direct Action Day to demand Pakistan, resulting in communal riots in Calcutta and further polarization between Hindus and Muslims.

Mountbatten Plan(1947)

- ▶ The British government agrees to the partition of India, leading to the creation of the independent states of India and Pakistan.

Independence and Partition (1947)

- ▶ On August 14, 1947, Pakistan is established as an independent nation, fulfilling the Muslim League's demand for a separate homeland for Muslims.

Conclusion

- ▶ The Muslim struggle for the creation of Pakistan was shaped by a series of political and constitutional developments between 1900 and 1940. From the formation of the Muslim League to the Lahore Resolution, the demand for a separate Muslim state emerged as a response to the perceived failure of the Indian political system to protect Muslim interests in a Hindu-majority India